

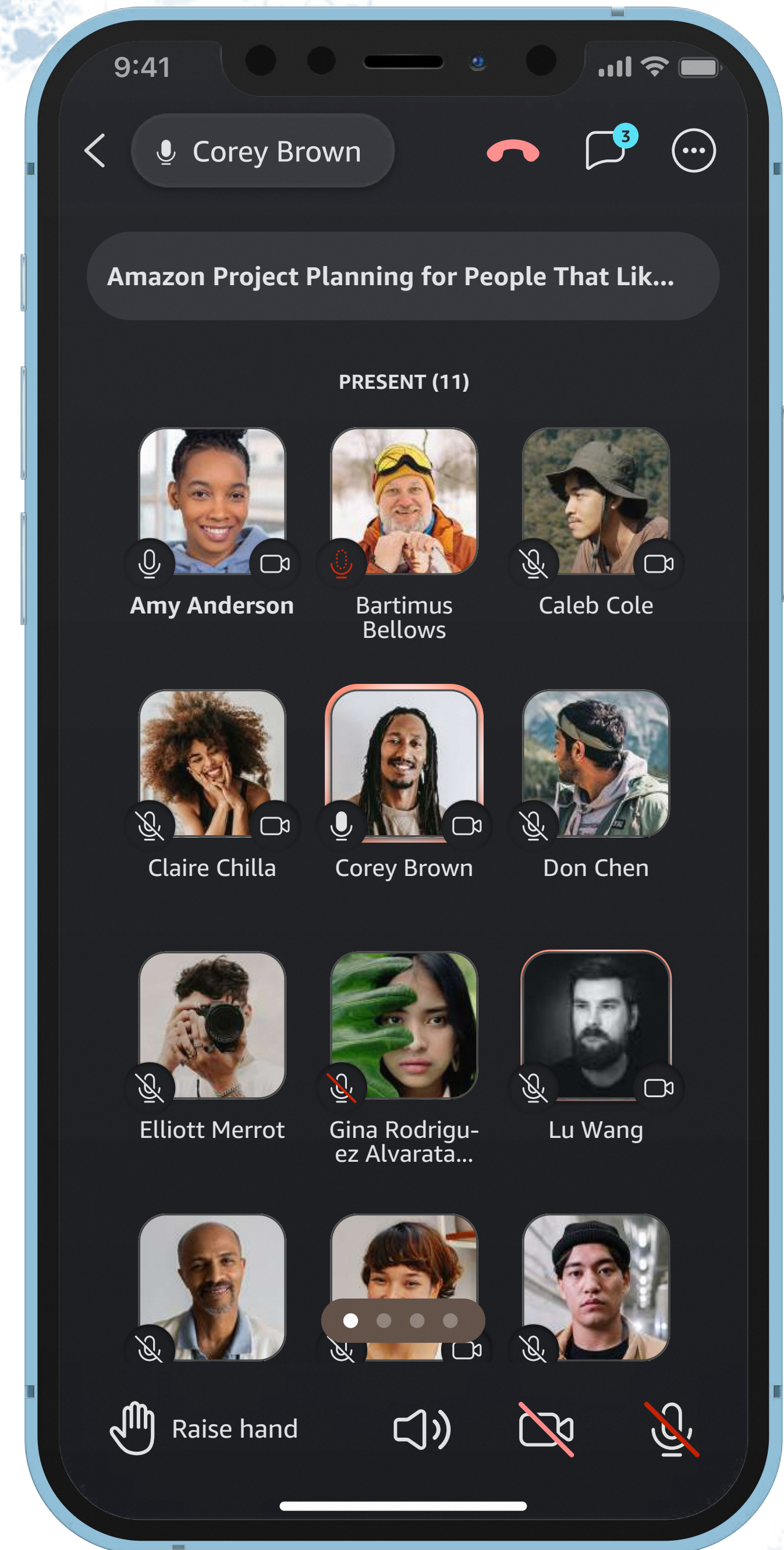


Amazon Chime

5.0 release design

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Senior Product Designer



THE CHEATSHEET

Org Goal



Win “hearts & minds” of Amazonian users—
The GM of Productivity Apps tasked us with this goal. The product was essentially unchanged since 2016 acquisition, and COVID-19 conferencing demands prompted a massive UI, UX, and back-end overhaul.

My role

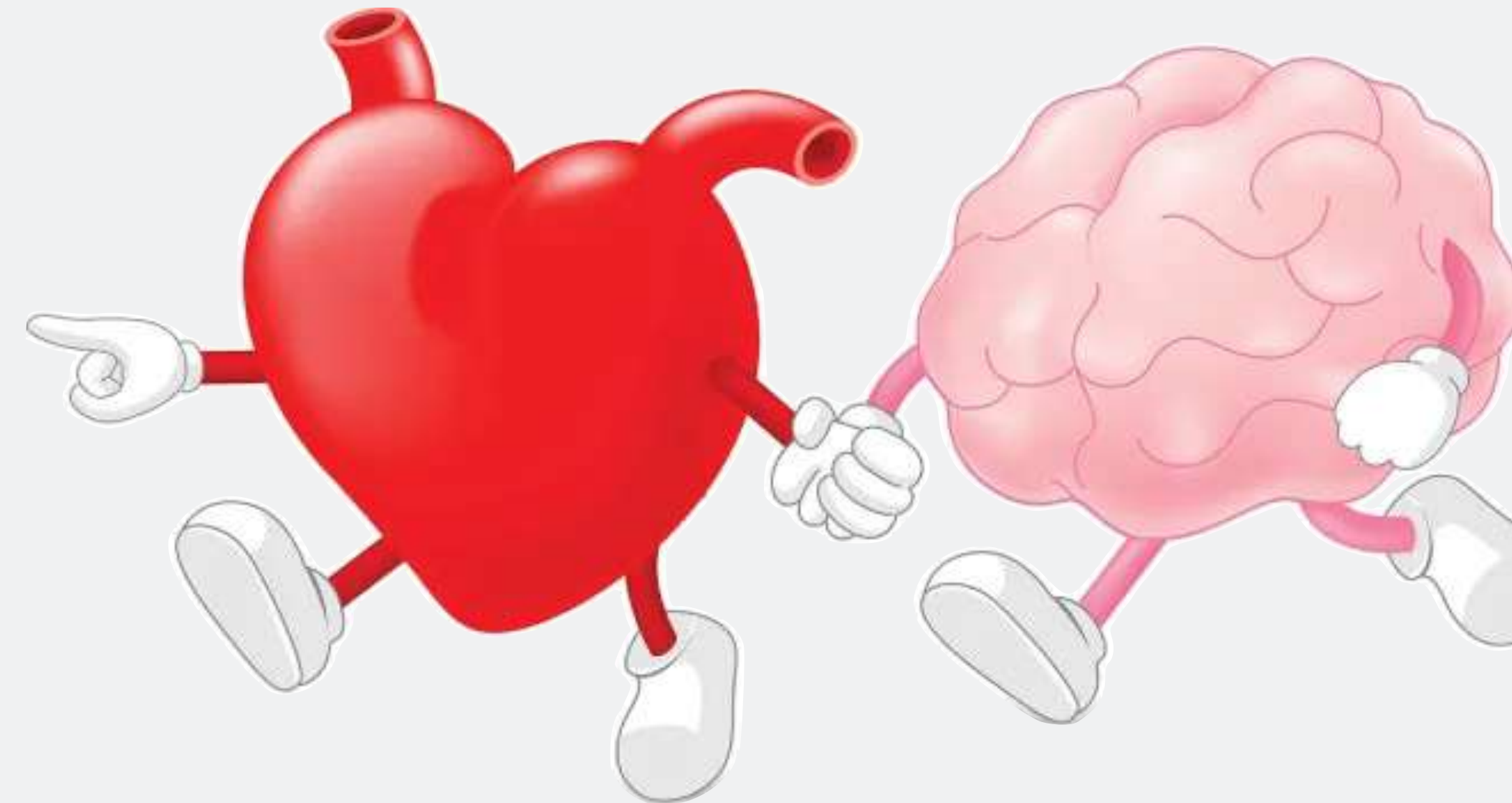
Direct large-scale product update of iOS & Android, fast-following desktop’s work.

Designed for...

Knowledge workers that thrive on schedule flexibility without losing availability.

Opening Challenges

- ♦ **Amazon Chime was not beloved**
Hence the goal. The strategy was to create a better product by winning over internal users, but we had to overcome broken trust.
- ♦ **No research, ambiguous success metrics**
“Win the hearts & minds of Amazonians” didn’t come with clear data or goals. We needed to find ways to quantify and justify decisions.
- ♦ **Platform-silo’d teams, no dedicated PM**
Mobile’s kick-off was just me and an engineering manager, then hiring up his team of 5 iOS & 5 Android engineers.
- ♦ **We all wore many hats to compensate**
I filled in gaps for mobile’s leadership, acting as interim PM, project manager, and ultimately running the beta testing program.



BACK TO BASICS

Charting mobile’s voyage

Desktop’s engineering team was ahead of mobile and frustrated by the grind. As interim PM, I interviewed their leads to see what our scrappy mobile team needed for success:

- ✦ Define scope & impact
- ✦ Lead with user research
- ✦ Map a clear forward path
- ✦ Communicate intentionally & often
- ✦ Document thoroughly

DISCOVER — EXPLORE — ITERATE — BUILD

2

UX Deliverables Index for NME mobile (archived)

H1

Master Doc: Chime Meetings NME 5.0 - Reference Links

Chime Meetings - 5.x NME Product Discussions (archived)

Prototypes and UI

Listed below, most current one on top.

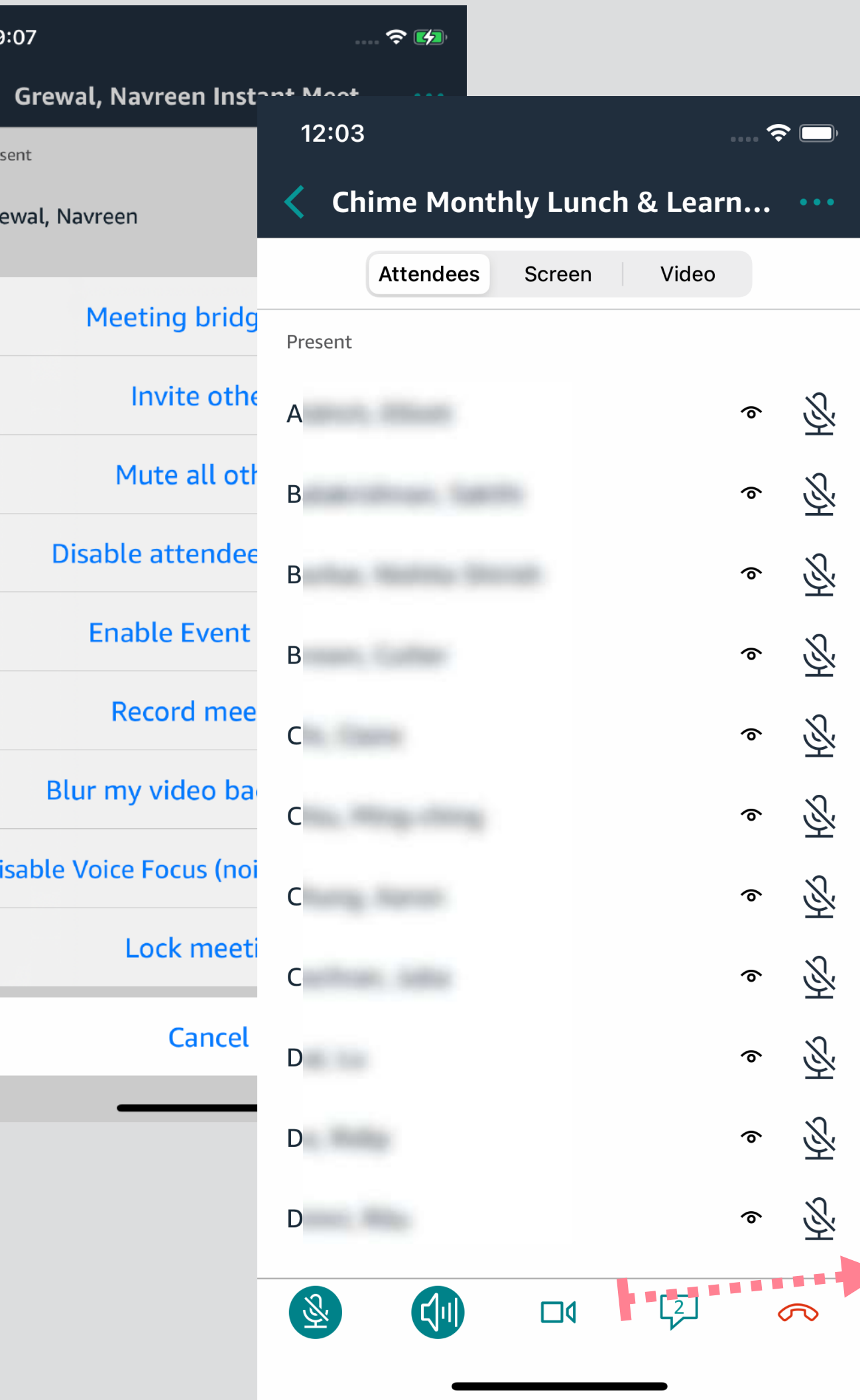
	A	B	C	D	E
1		Phase	Link		
2	May 2022	UX Specs	https://zpl.io/mDXBmm9	Done	
3	Jan 2022	UI - Join Flow	https://zpl.io/amJwyyv	Done	
4	May 2022	UI - Mobile Meeting	https://zpl.io/aXj6jrj	Done	
5	Aug 2021	UI - Avatars	https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm	Done	
6	Aug 2021	UI - Mira Design System	https://zpl.io/bP7KnwD	Done	
7	April 2022	Dark Mode- rest of app	[Req] Mobile 5.x reskin Current CX screenshots	Done	
8	Feb 2022	Dark Mode - Meeting CX	https://zpl.io/qyZOZnN	Done	
9					
10	May 2022	App store screens	https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm	Done	
11	June 2022	Enlarge screenshare	[Proposed UX] Screenshare to full [r2]	Done	
12	April 2022	Accessibility docs	Accessibility	Done	https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm
13	New	Dogfood Mobile 5.0 Beta	Beta Sign Up Wiki	Done/State	Mobile 5.0 Dogfood
14	Jan 2022	NME UI Audit	UI Audit	Done	
15	--	UX - Audio cues	In-App Audio Cues	Unfinished	
16	Aug 2021	UX - Meeting alerts	In-Meeting Event Messaging	Done	
17	Aug 2021	Chime Analytics Req	Analytics to implement - Top things we want to learn	Done	UX Metrics Wishlist
18					
19	June 2021	Prototype Walkthrough video	https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm	Done	
20	June 2021	Iteration Prototype	https://amazon.invisionapp.com/share/K210WEAFSFU	Done	Password: beluga
21	Aug 2021	Iteration Active Speaker	https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm	Done	Test gifs from VX a
22	June 2021	6/18 Prototype Assets	https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm	Done	
23					
24	May 2021	Chimehouse Ideation	https://www.figma.com/proto/oIhn6YlwMi9pURbkAw	Done	
25	Apr 2021	Meeting Controls Usability	https://amazon.invisionapp.com/share/AN111UETVTB	Done	Password: chime
26	Apr 2021	Exploration Prototype	https://amazon.invisionapp.com/share/XB111UEJGRC	Done	Password: beluga
27					

Completed Research

A	B	C	D	E	F
	Research	Summary	Link	Raw notes/data	
Jan 2022	5.X Bravehearts Survey	Survey beta testers about their mee	2022 February - Beta Feedback S	https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm	Done
Nov 2021	Join Flow Usability	A/B Usability for 2 variations	2021 November Join Flow Red	https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm	Done
Sept 2021	Beta Usability r1	In-complete first pass usability	https://issues.amazon.com/Chime	Reactions: https://amazon.invisionapp.com/share/AN111UETVTB	Done
May 2021	Mobile Meeting Analytics	Quant data for mobile meetings	2021 May - Mobile Meetings Dat	https://issues.amazon.com/Chime	Done
Apr 2021	Meeting Controls Usability	A/B Usability for 2 variations	2021 April - Usability Findings	2021 April - Meet	Done
Mar 2021	User Interviews	In-depth interviews for Chime meetings on mobile usage	2021 Mar User Interview Finding	2021 Mar - Mobil	Done
Dec 2020	Chime Mobile Survey	Survey sent to bravehearts and interest	https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm		Done

HIGH IMPACT changes needed to be identified

Discovery research of 14 interviews, a survey, and a quant report of 375 mill. users provided critical data I used to identify impactful effort.



Roster as meeting “home”

- ✦ Lacks clear active speaker cue
- ✦ Lacks virtual presence (e.g. pics)

LOW COST

HIGH COST

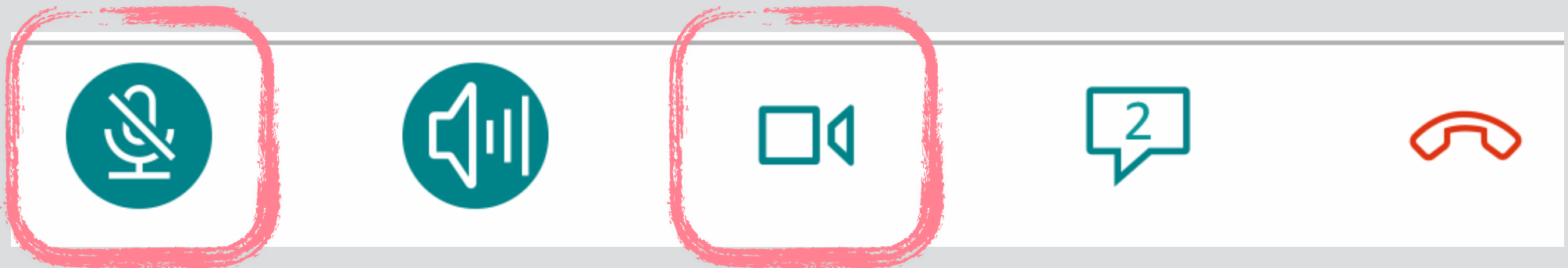


Clear architecture & controls—

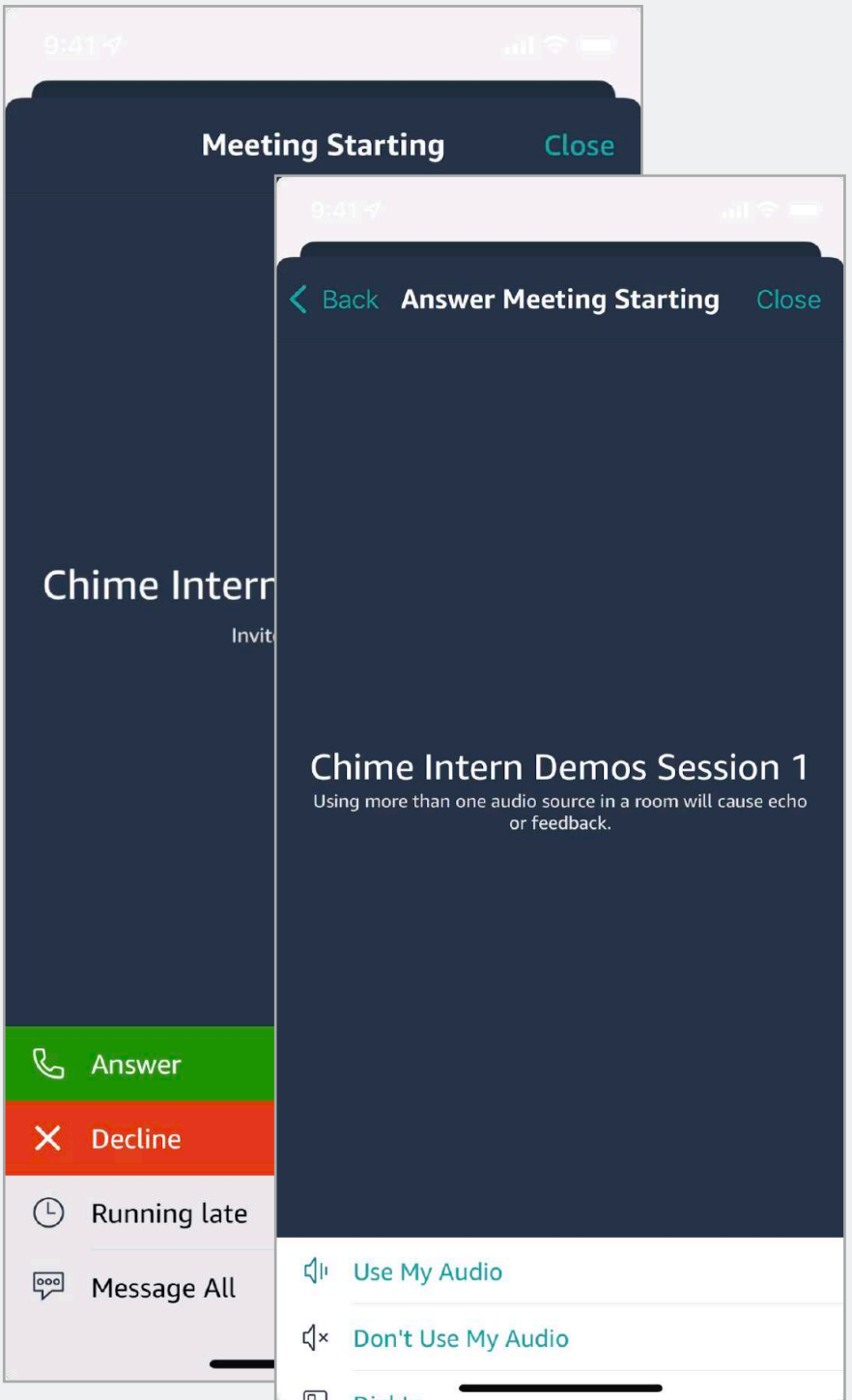
(source of most user complaints)

- ✦ Confusing mic & camera status
- ✦ Lots of accidental meeting exits
- ✦ No “raise hand” feature
- ✦ Muddled menu & options

MED-HIGH COST



Guess your mic & camera status...



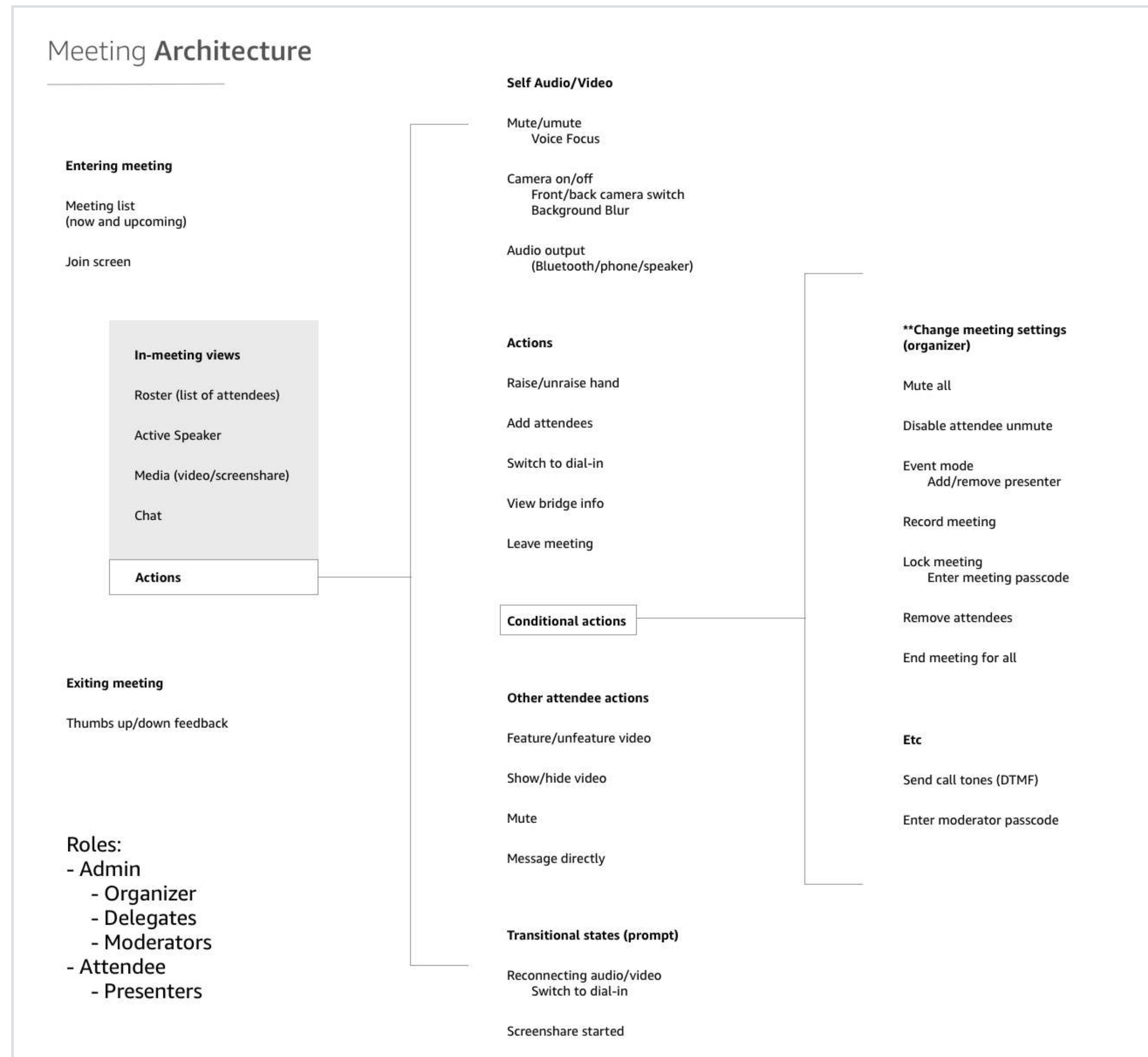
Reduced join friction—

currently 2 steps, more difficult while on the move

MED-LOW COST

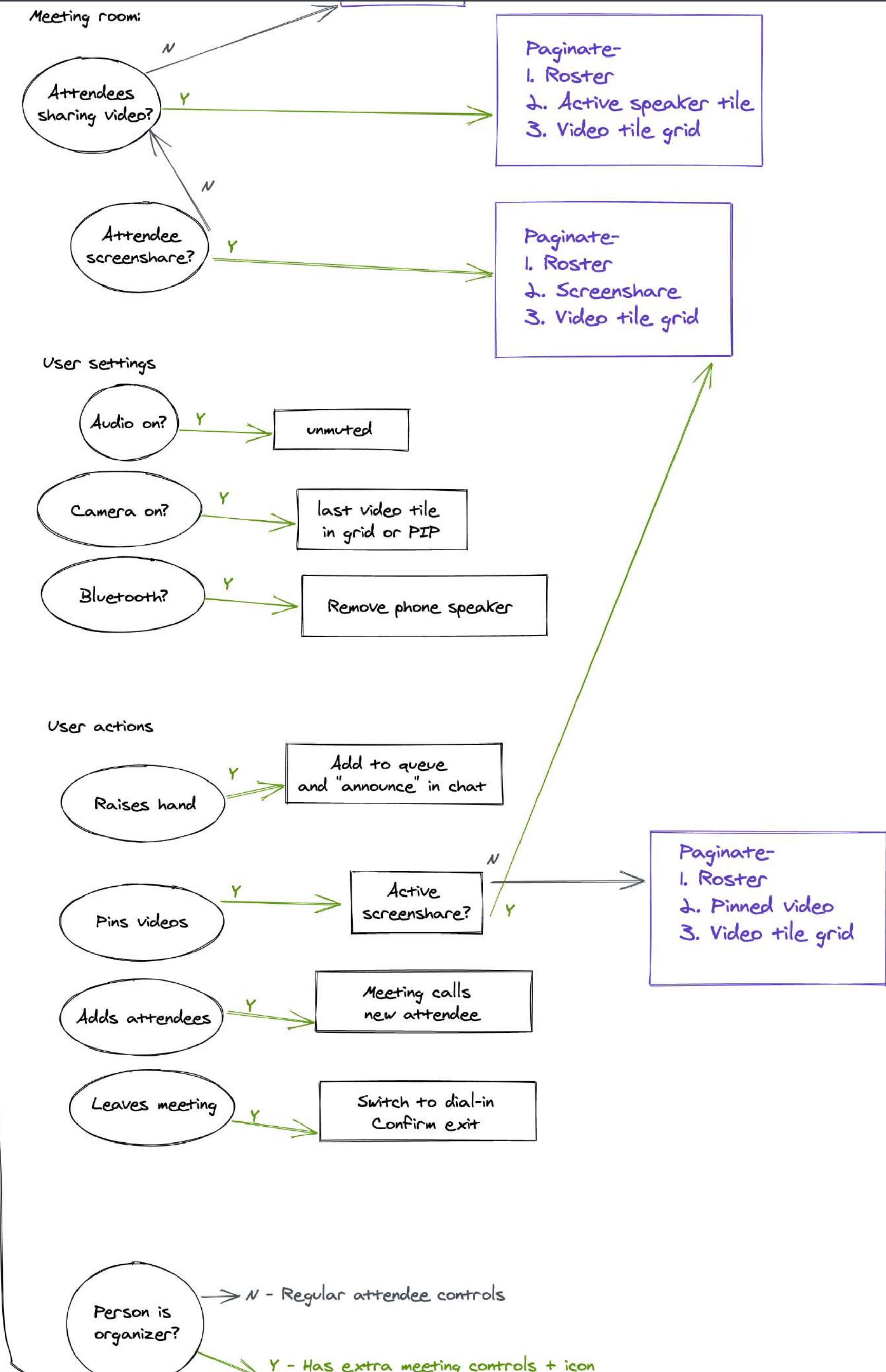
Meeting architecture was an internal mystery

Functionality varied across platforms, and lack of documentation made scoping discussions difficult. I Nancy Drew'd the details to better organize all the actions, options, and permissions available to users.



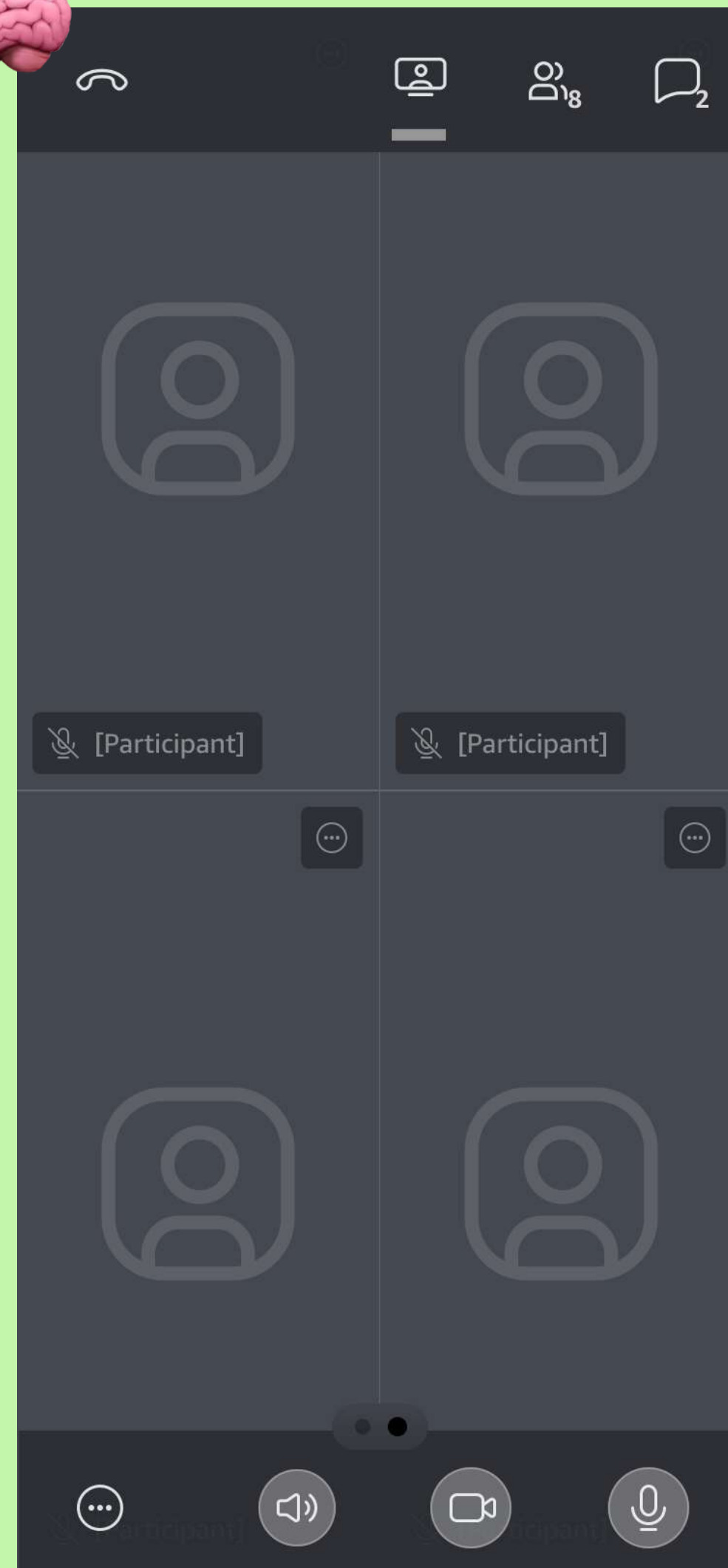
User starts on:

Roster



Early testing corrected big assumptions

Usability of 10 participants with 2 clickable prototypes and card sort quickly settled disagreements over big decisions.

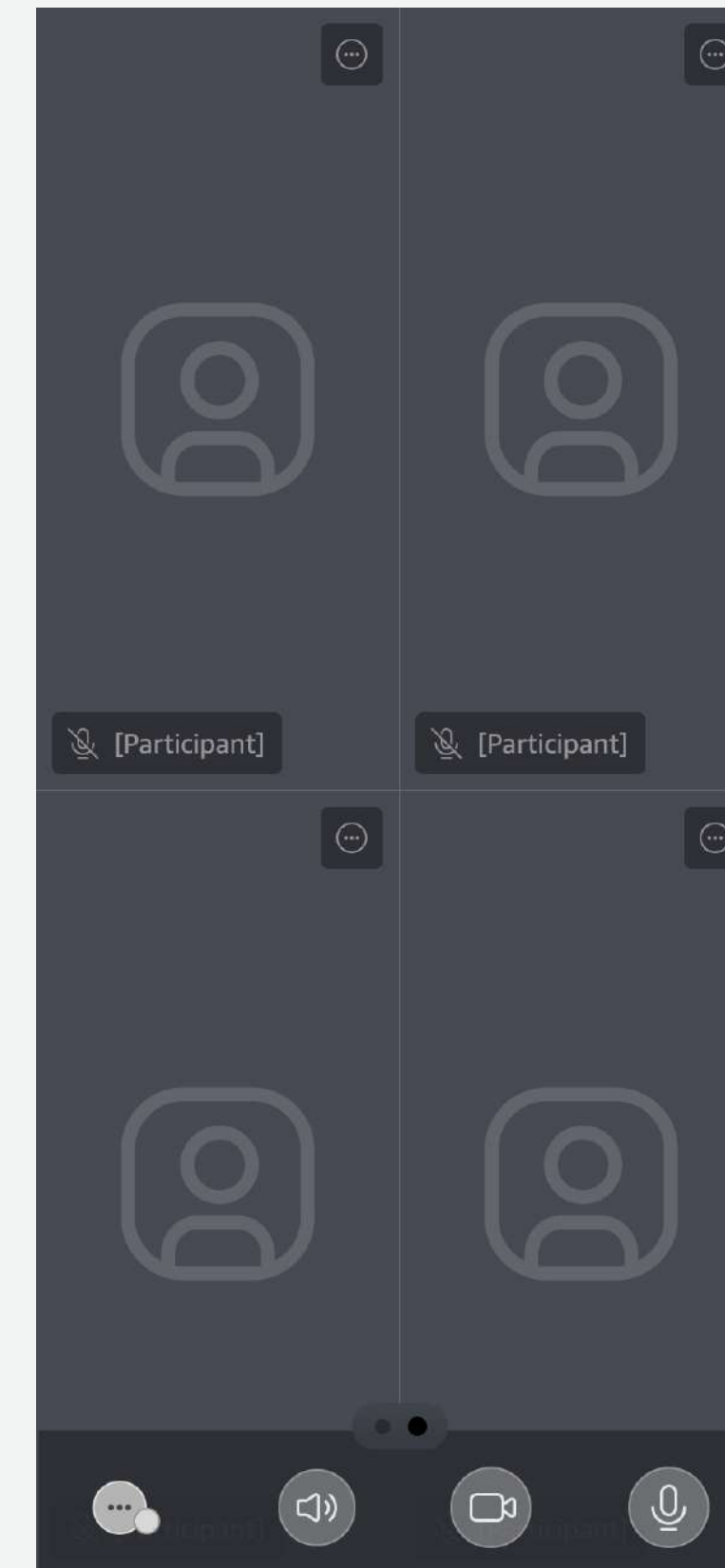


Var A - Classic

- Preferred quick access to roster & chat
- Addition of count in roster & chat was highly appreciated
- Most were thrilled the end call button was “out of the way”

Bonus validation

- Almost all participants didn't want to start on video—they sought the list of attendees first

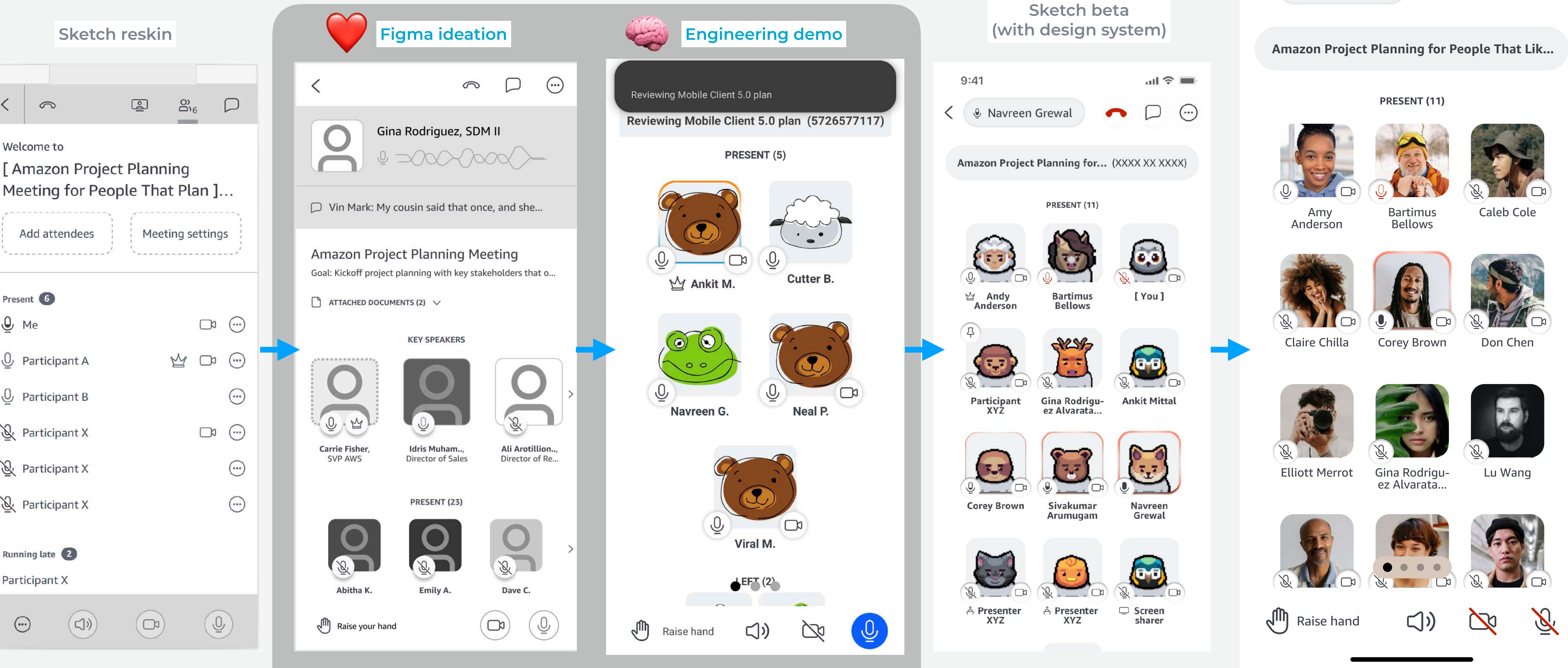


Var B - Thumb optimized

- Many were uneasy without access to roster
- Many quickly understood anything missing is in ellipses button

Roster had the boldest overhaul

This best reflects the app’s overall evolution. Engineering was understandably nervous about large-effort changes. Along with usability data and feasibility talks, they became comfortable pushing the envelope by building a demo in tandem with design.

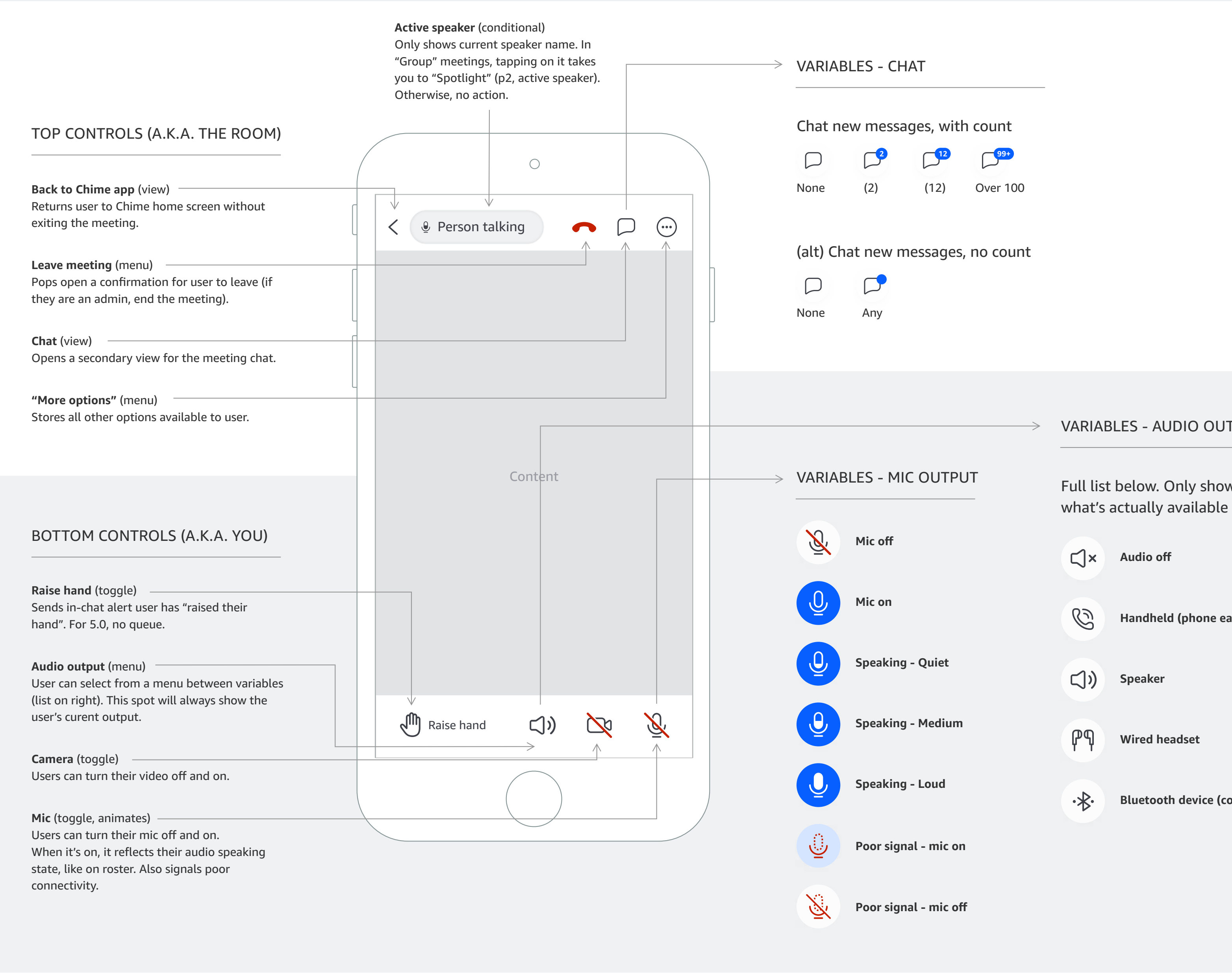


MAKE IT SO

Design spec handoff

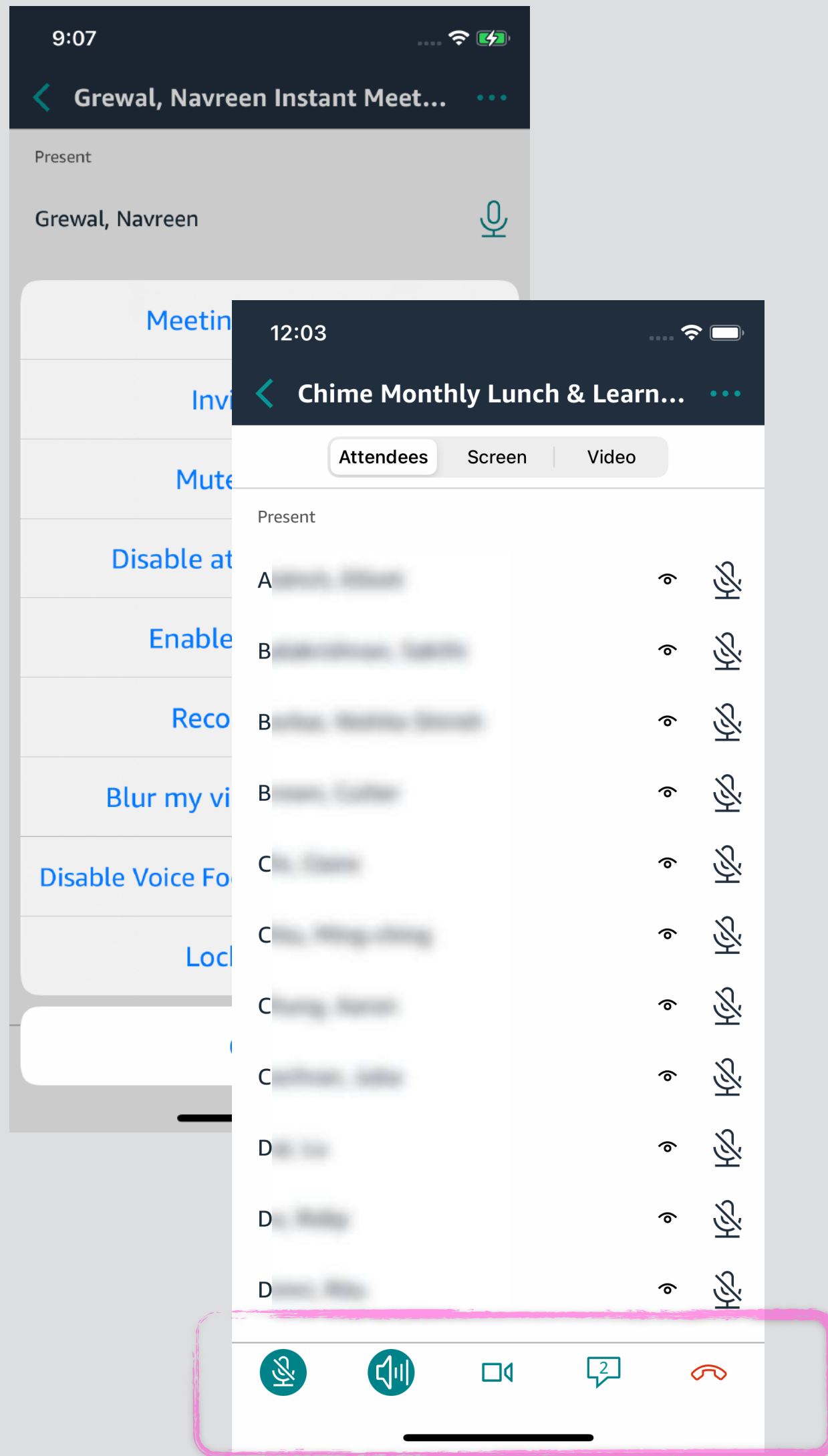
Engineering and I volleyed this way until launch. In the end, I created a finalized UX “spec” for these benefits:

- ◆ Capture what we defined collaboratively—architecture, interactions, and design system
- ◆ Reassure project newcomers that a methodical approach was taken
- ◆ Reduce interpretation gaps through clear documentation

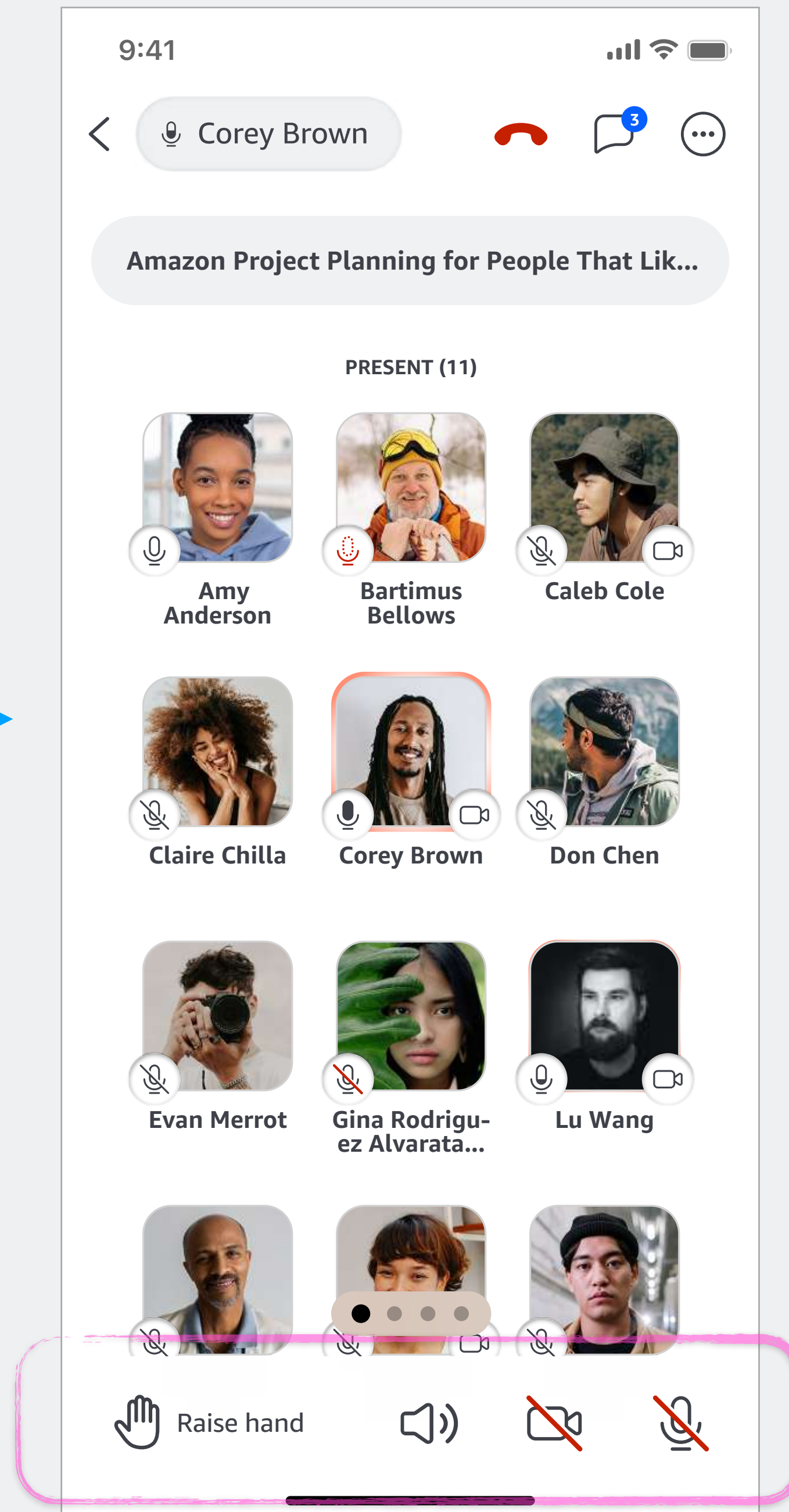
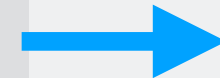


YOU'LL BE SO TIRED OF WINNING

5.0's  &  redesign



4.39 Roster & Menu
(muted + speaker)



THE AFTER

Meeting room (roster/attendees)

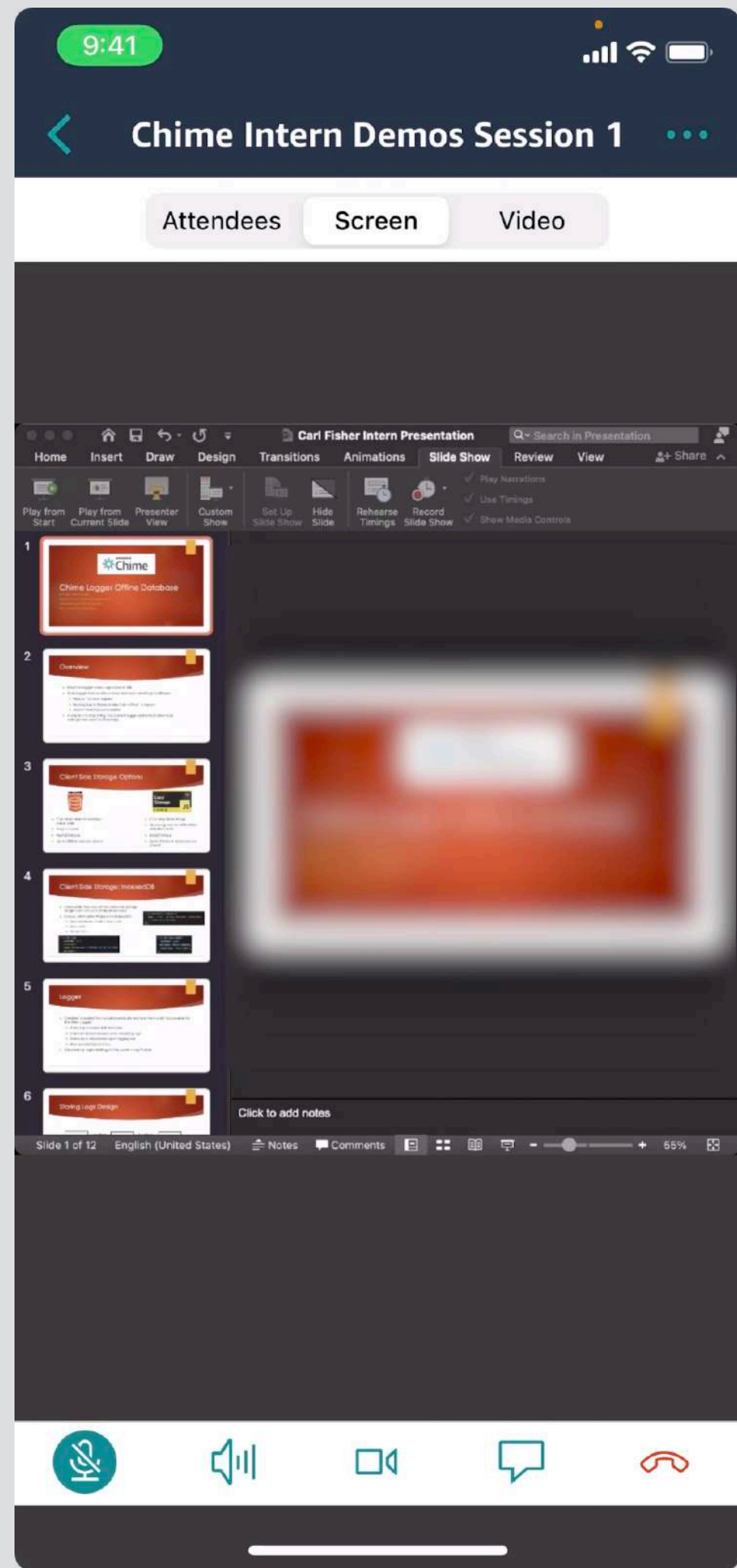
- Persistent and clear “active speaker” cues
- Virtual presence with photos

Meeting controls

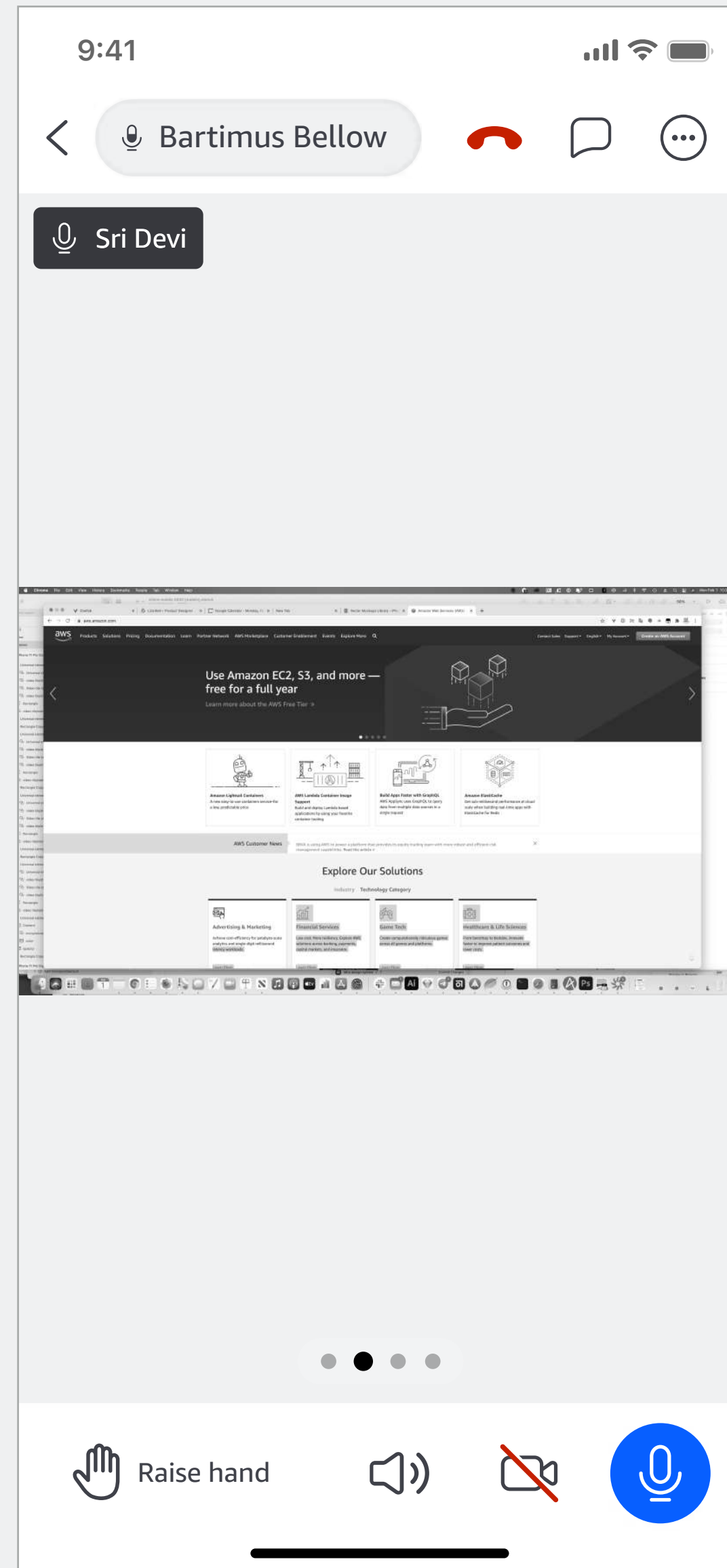
- Clear video/ audio toggle states
- Move infrequently used options away from thumb

Menus & alerts

- Restructure options and alerts across platforms, utilizing native patterns
- Reduce cross-platform discrepancies



4.39



5.0 (Screenshare, active speaker video)

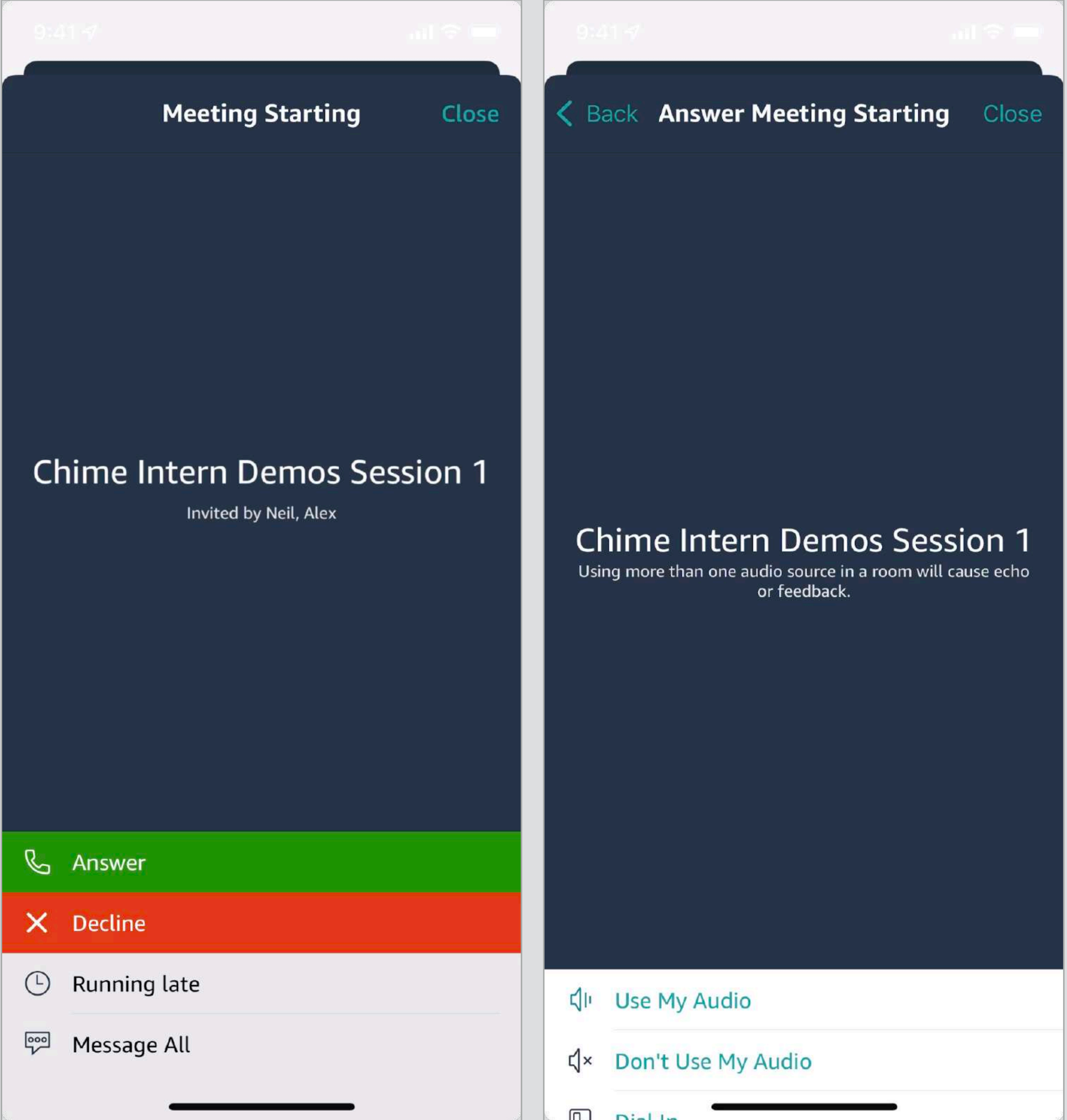


THE AFTER

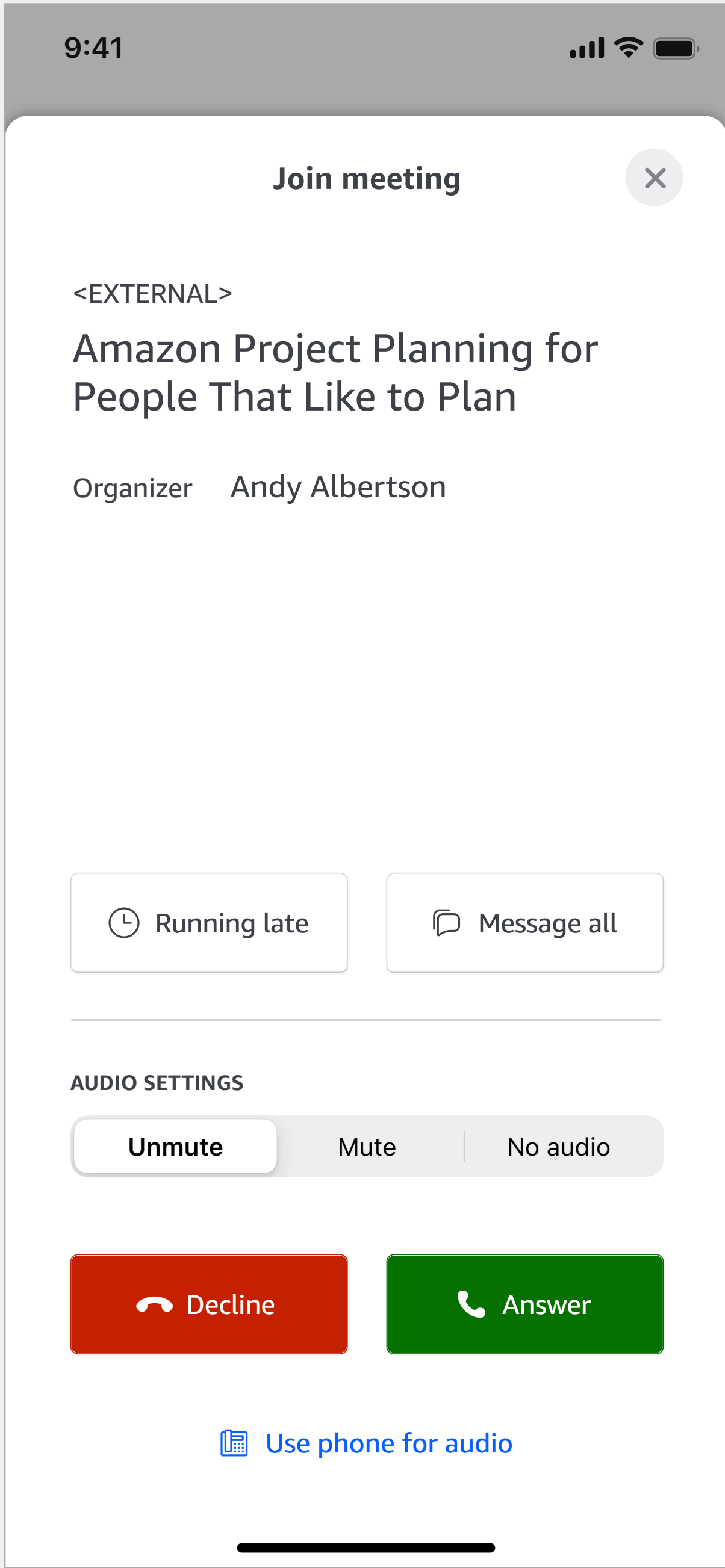
Spotlight

- Adaptive “Spotlight” shows meeting focal point (screen share → active speaker → pinned video)
- Expanded screenshare interactions—zoom, pan, horizontal orientation





4.39



5.0

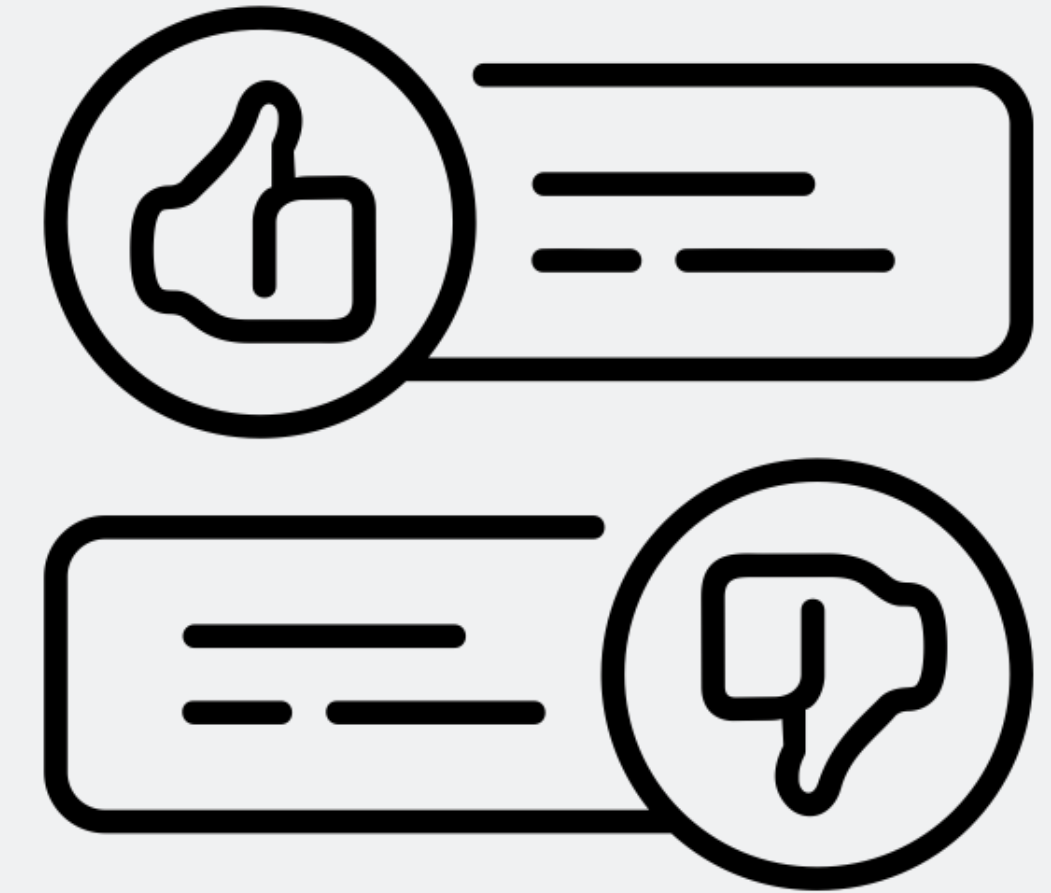
THE AFTER

Join meeting

- Consolidate “join meeting” steps
- Simplify audio settings while adding new options—join muted or unmuted
- Save last used audio setting
- Prioritize options according to data and usability

Feedback from beta users

Several usability sessions and 3 in-depth surveys of over 400 participants showed an **86% average satisfaction** rating from Amazonians (a very tough crowd). Most negative feedback were around the animal placeholders and lack of dark mode, which would be fixed in the final launch.

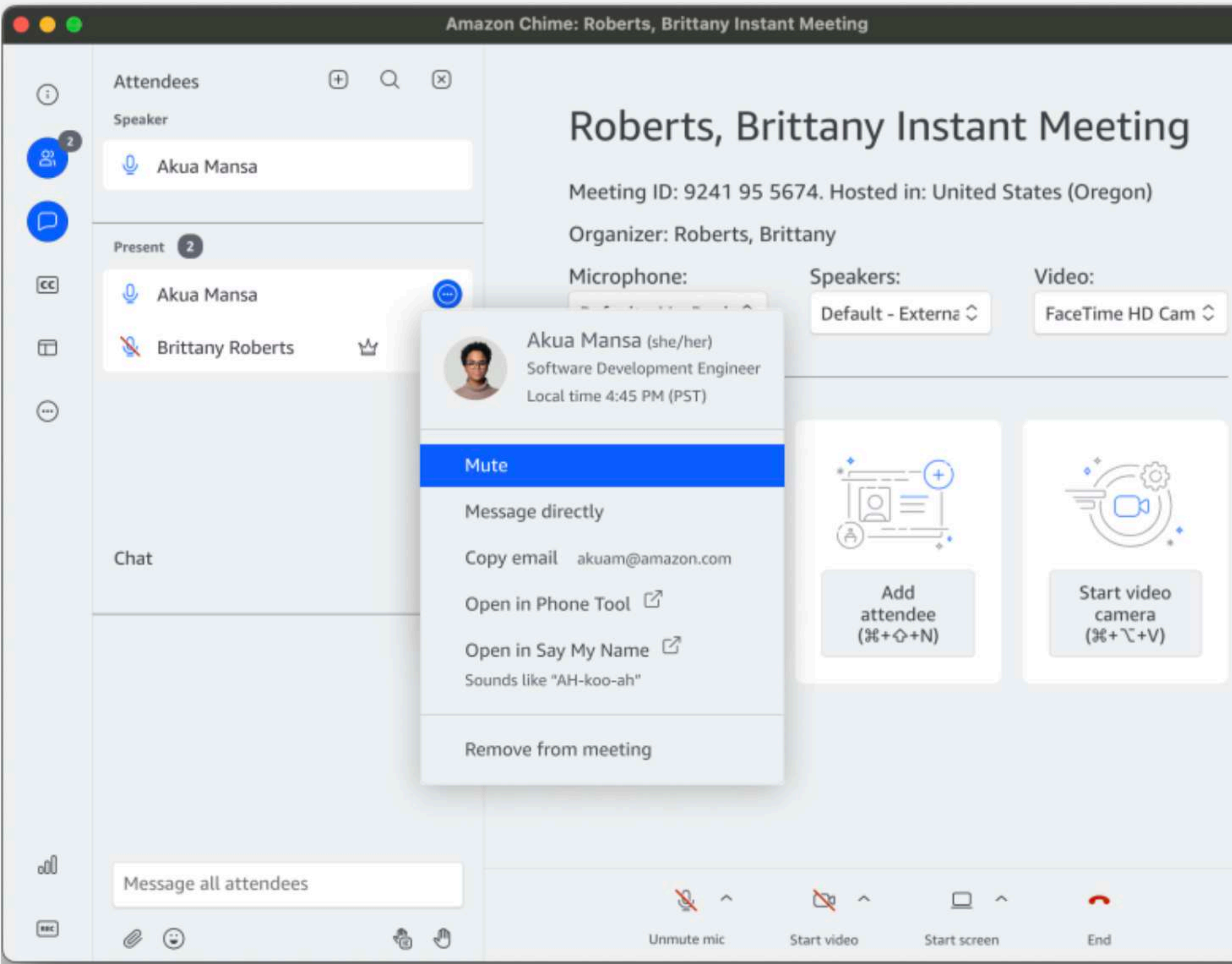
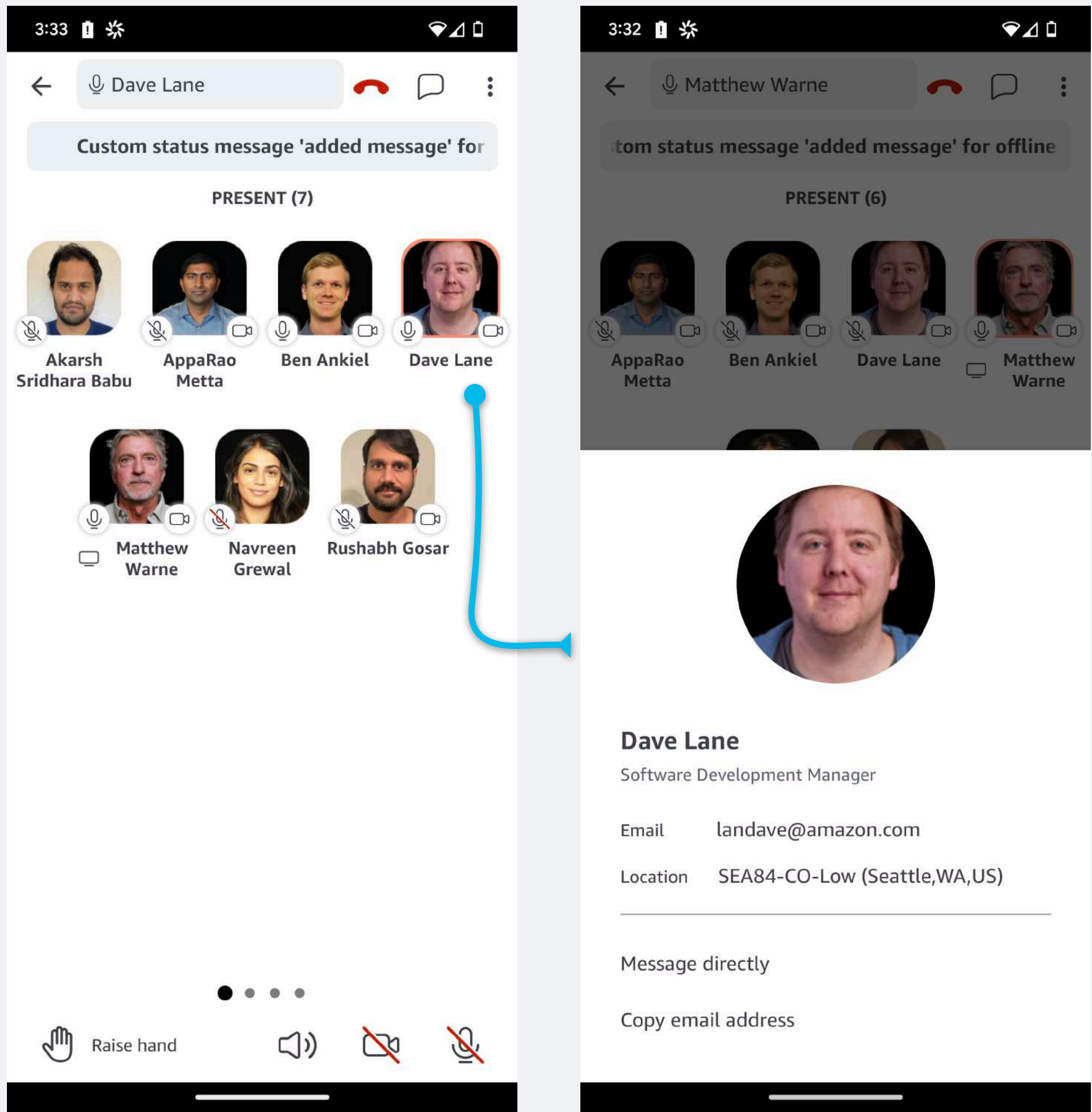


- + “I like the new user interface. it looks cleaner, and i had an easier time finding the controls.”
- + “While driving easy to listen not miss any info was my super power.”
- + “I like the first page with all the participants and that i can use the raise hand functionality”
- + “I love the animals! it adds some fun character and a little bit of the goofyness of amazon that's missing so much these days.”

- “I strongly dislike the animal icons...actual pictures of people would be more helpful.”
- “This is so bright at night when is dark mode coming?!”

Profile pics were worth the cost to build

This feature was considered costly and got a lot of pushback, but user data showed it was strongly desired. After launch, it received such positive feedback that it catalyzed our desktop team into figuring out integration. It also lead to deeper profile view across platforms.



ROOM FOR IMPROVEMENT

Launch & learn

The redesign reduced complaints about basic meeting issues. User requests shifted focus to feature ideas and improvements:

- ✦ Roster needed continued refinement—previews of meeting chat messages, indications of screen share in progress, and a grid/list view
- ✦ Mobile users desired a more prominent mic, and left-handed users complained of the button being too far out of reach.
- ✦ Driving mode was a known demand but had to be descope from 5.0. It had to be a high priority follow-up on the roadmap.
- ✦ Profile pics lead to demand for customization

5.X follow-up

